

Component	Advisor Purpose
9 Growth Stages	Identify Current Position
5 Layers of Complexity	Identify Dominant Psyche Error
7 Growth Focus Tactics	Identify Next Tactical Focus
Devil's Toilet	Recognise Profit Plateau Levels
Split Point	Recognise Missing Skill Sets
9 Growth Aspects	Maintain Awareness

9 Growth Stages	Growth Description
Exit/Decline	The business owners realise their capital gain via 'going-concern' sale or MBO to 'groomed staff'/Succession to family members. (If successful) OR The business dwindles as the owner/s seek retirement. (If they missed the mark)
Maturity	The business now commands a sizable market-share and creates a 'barrier to entry' for any business looking to compete against it.
Leapfrog	The business now enjoys the ability to purchase or merge with 'like-minded' competitors. Market share is now substantial...
Reach	The business is now enjoying multiple locations as the 'brand' is beginning to spread. New (additional) products are also part of your world!
Leverage	The business can sustain the lifestyle of the owner/s without the owner/s being directly 'hands-on' on a daily basis.
Lifestyle	The business makes enough profit to allow the owner/s to draw sufficient funds to meet their lifestyle and save money each month.
Break-even	The business makes enough money to cover costs.
Launch	Opening the doors and sharing your dream with the world!
Design	Developing your business concept, getting ready to leave your job!

What Got You Here...	Stage	What Holds You Back...
Recognition that either the business has 'outgrown you' or it's opportunistic to realise the 'good-will' you've created with both customers and staff alike.	Exit/Decline	Failure to have developed inherent value beyond that of your own personal involvement. Perhaps lack of vision for 'life after business'..?
Vision, Discipline and a willingness to adapt to the needs of your business and marketplace; combined with a sound knowledge of financial and business fundamentals.	Maturity	Lack of financial management expertise; focus shifted from being customer centric to becoming absorbed with internal and 'political' issues. Lost 'contact' with the marketplace.
Sound business model with clarity of your customer's drivers and the opportunity for ancillary services/products. Opportunity to capture market share with alternative distribution.	Leapfrog	Lack of understanding of the 'Epistemology' behind your potential alliance or acquisition partner combined with fragile Governance protocols. (Perhaps numerics 'just don't add up'?)
Proven systems and market acceptance of product/service combined with brand awareness in local marketplace. Key staff capable of 'stepping up'.	Reach	Lack of knowledge around 'consumer dynamics' as they relate to the new marketplace or product/service that you plan to adopt.
Recognition of market demand (potential) and the need to meet it in order to stay competitive, combined with desire to have business less reliant on owner/s.	Leverage	Lack of faith in Key Staff (may be well founded) combined with poor delegation/visibility/review procedures. Perhaps a reluctance to 'let go' or a business model built around the 'specialist' service provider model. Governance ethos is not yet ingrained throughout.
A clear understanding of the value you offer your customers and the financial awareness of 'what makes a difference & what doesn't'...	Lifestyle	Lack of clarity around your business numerics or lack of discipline in completing the tasks that matter, on time.
Significant work and effort combined with a strong focus on customer delivery.	Break-even	Lack of financial management or sales/marketing basics, strained resources and fatigue...
Determined to 'have a go' and armed with enough supporting information to believe 'it's possible'...	Launch	Realisation of the task enormity and financial risks of failure. Perhaps legitimate timing or resource obstacles.
Frustrated with current income, lack of autonomy or time freedom combined with the desire to 'see what you're capable of'...	Design	Current job security and fear of the unknown. Times of complete clarity and sense of purpose clashed with doubt and resource fears...

Complexity Layers	Principles	5 Psyche Errors
5.Succession	Principles that give rise to understanding The Separation of Value & Worth. "Learning to get out of your own way"	(Trying to Avoid) Over-Identification
4.Expansion	Principles that give rise to understanding the Chaos of Interdependency and Affect. "There's a fine line between Expansion and Explosion"	(Trying to Avoid) Over-Exposure
3.Intelligence	Principles that give rise to Contextual Awareness "Learning to Notice What You Don't Know"	(Trying to Avoid) Optimism Bias
2.Orientation	Principles that give rise to understanding Your Purpose & Meaning. "Knowing Your Why & How"	(Trying to Avoid) Complacency
1.Foundation	Principles that give rise to understanding How things Work. "Being Curious – Open Heart & Open Mind"	(Trying to Avoid) Confirmation Bias

9 Growth Aspects	Aspect Description
Process Improvement	Operations, Work In Progress, Transactional Volume, Quality Control, Internal Statistics & Data Collection.
Customer Focus	Their Experience, (Our) Product / Service Delivery & Development.
Sales (Process)	Achieving Critical Revenue Objectives (consistently), Securing Resource, Managing Critical External Relations.
Authenticity	Values (Cultural), Marketing (Outbound Messaging), Aesthetics, 'Feel' (Vibe/Morale), Packaging.
Inventory & Equipment	Consumable Stock, Materials or Supplies, Tools, Machinery, Vehicles, Non-Consumable Working Assets.
Team Focus	Skills Development, Internal Communication, Change Management, Recruitment, Knowledge Management, Rewards/ Incentives.
Innovation	Technology, Disruption, (External) Research & Development, Re-Invention.
Governance	Vision, Strategic Planning, Sound Decision (Financial) Making Process, Leadership, Communication Lines, Financial Management, Risk Management.
Harmony / Balance	Removing Distractions, Health & Fitness, 'Well-Being', Recovering (Financial also).

"Growth Curve"

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** It visually maps the entirety of the business journey, preparing the owner for predictable challenges like the "Devil's Toilet" (a dangerous profit plateau) before they hit them. It clearly defines the missing skill sets and the psychological traps ("Psyche Errors") they might fall into at each stage.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It provides a master reference tool to accurately diagnose the client's current stage, next tactical focus, and dominant psychological barriers.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Clients who need a comprehensive, high-level overview of their entire business lifecycle to understand how the moving parts (stages, tactics, aspects) fit together.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Identify Current Position:** Use the 9 Growth Stages (Design to Exit/Decline) to pinpoint where the business currently sits.
2. **Identify Next Tactical Focus:** Look at the 7 Growth Focus Tactics (e.g., Enthusiasm & Creativity, Clarity & Strategy) to determine what actions the client must take next.
3. **Recognise Profit Plateaus:** Map the client's fatigue or stagnation against the "Devil's Toilet" to show them the dangers of the gap between the 'Lifestyle' and 'Leverage' stages.
4. **Diagnose Missing Skills & Psyche Errors:** Identify the client's layer of complexity (Foundation, Orientation, Intelligence, Expansion, Succession) and match it to their dominant Psyche Error (e.g., Confirmation Bias, Complacency).
5. **Maintain Awareness:** Review the 9 Growth Aspects (e.g., Customer Focus, Governance, Harmony/Balance) to ensure holistic business management is maintained.

Common Q&A:

1. *What is the "Devil's Toilet"?* It is a dangerous metaphorical rapid (profit plateau) between the 'lifestyle' and 'leverage' stages where owners experience high complacency and fatigue.
2. *What are the 8 Profit Levers?* They are: Number of Foot-traffic, Number of Prospects, Number of Customers, Average Customer Spend, Average Customer Frequency, Sales Margin, Activity Driven Costs, and Fixed Costs.
3. *What drives "Complacency"?* Complacency is driven by the mind and body's requirement to recover after sustained periods of exhaustion, often manifesting upon reaching a stage of perceived security.

4. *What happens at the "Split Point"?* The split point is a divergent path on the curve where a business either moves upward into Maturity or begins to slope toward Exit/Decline based on missing skill sets.
 5. *What is "Role Identification"?* It is a psyche error in the Succession layer where a person mimics a mentor or acts out how they think a 'Boss' should behave, resulting in inauthentic decision-making.
 6. *What are the 5 Layers of Complexity?* Foundation, Orientation, Intelligence, Expansion, and Succession.
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"Growth Curve Story"

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** It translates complex business metrics into a highly relatable, narrative-driven visual format, making it easy to see exactly "What Got You Here" versus "What Holds You Back".
- **How it helps the advisor:** The illustrative nature of the slide deck makes it easier for the advisor to explain complex hurdles, utilizing characters and visuals rather than overwhelming the client with raw data.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Visual learners and clients who respond better to storytelling and narrative context rather than analytical spreadsheets.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Set the Stage:** Introduce the framework with the premise: "Where you came from, Where you are now, Where you're headed..."
2. **Locate the Client's Story Chapter:** Find the visual slide corresponding to their current stage (e.g., "Breakeven" or "Leverage") and display the accompanying illustration.
3. **Review the 3 Fundamentals:** For that specific stage, walk through the 3 specific structural fundamentals required (e.g., in 'Launch', discuss ROI/ROA, 8 Profit Levers, and P&L organization).
4. **Validate Past Efforts:** Use the "What Got You Here" prompt to acknowledge the hard work, vision, or discipline the client has utilized so far.
5. **Address the Roadblocks:** Use the "What Holds You Back" prompt to highlight the specific fears, lack of knowledge, or missing management expertise preventing them from progressing.

Common Q&A:

1. *What holds a business back in the 'Design' stage?* Current job security, fear of the unknown, and times of complete clarity clashing with doubt and resource fears.
 2. *What are the 3 Fundamentals required during the 'Leverage' stage?* Sound Delegation & Feedback Protocols, Robust Understanding of Process Improvement, and Grounded Knowledge of Leadership Styles.
 3. *What is the Growth Focus during 'Reach'?* Growth through delegation, replication, or quantification.
 4. *What holds a business back in the 'Maturity' stage?* A lack of financial management expertise and shifting focus from being customer-centric to becoming absorbed with internal 'political' issues.
 5. *What got a business to the 'Leapfrog' stage?* A sound business model with clarity of customer drivers and the opportunity to capture market share with alternative distribution.
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"Reveal the Curve"

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** By viewing the framework drawn in measured "chunks," the owner experiences an interactive process that prevents them from feeling overwhelmed.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It gives the advisor an exact, step-by-step facilitation script, ensuring they use third-person dissociation to avoid judgment, overcome the "boring accountant" stereotype, and secure client buy-in.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** New clients during initial consultations, or existing clients embarking on a new strategic advisory engagement.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Prepare the Canvas:** Begin drawing the curve freehand, ensuring you include the Devil's Toilet and the Split Point (tell the client you will explain these later).
2. **Position the Framework:** Write the title at the top and explain why you use it, using a third-person persona (e.g., "Let's take a look at it through the eyes of Bob the Chocolate maker").
3. **Reveal in Chunks:** Draw and briefly explain the curve in 3x3 chunks: First (Design, Launch, Breakeven), Second (Lifestyle, Leverage, Reach), and Third (Leapfrog, Maturity, Exit/Decline).
4. **Explain the Hazards:** Explain the dangers of the Devil's Toilet and the divergence at the Split Point.

5. **Test Understanding & Future Goals:** Ask the client where they think they sit on the curve and challenge them with, "WHAT makes you say that?" Then ask where they want to be and by when.
6. **Secure the Engagement:** Ask if they would be open to you bringing them ideas "in advance of problems or opportunities".

Common Q&A:

1. *Why use a persona like "Bob the Chocolate maker"?* It creates dissociation to avoid judgment before the concept is understood, keeps the delivery in the 3rd person, allows for humor, and reduces jargon.
2. *What are the three "Chunks" used to reveal the curve?* Chunk 1: Design-Launch-Breakeven. Chunk 2: Lifestyle-Leverage-Reach. Chunk 3: Leapfrog-Maturity-Exit/Decline.
3. *What is the specific question used to test a client's understanding?* "WHAT makes you say that?" after asking where they think they sit on the curve.
4. *Why should the advisor use storytelling?* To overcome the stigma/stereotype of accountants being purely logical and analytical, making clients actually want to spend time with them.
5. *How do you transition the drawing exercise into an ongoing service?* Explain that a list of 'knowledge blocks' are needed to make success easier, which reside in a checklist that you will review together in the future.

"org.Growth Fundamentals Framework Philosophy"

Benefits:

- **How it helps the business owner:** It helps them understand that a period of dormancy (homeostasis) is a natural requirement before growth, and uses memorable fables to highlight self-sabotaging biases.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It explicitly breaks down how to scale service delivery, providing both a 'Full' version (for larger fees/complex clients) and a 'Lite' version (for limited scope engagements).
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Stubborn clients experiencing deep-rooted psychological biases, or prospects where fee sensitivity dictates the need for a tailored, smaller-scope advisory product.

How to use the material in practice:

1. **Explain the Philosophy of Growth:** Present growth as a regenerative cycle on a 'Sigmoid-type' curve. Explain that 'frictional forces' (represented by colors) and 'gravitational forces' mean that climbing higher requires more energy and risk.
2. **Create Self-Relevance:** Establish context by helping the client recognize "where you are" based on knowing "where you've come from" and "where you're headed".
3. **Address Biases using Fables:** Identify the client's psychological block and tell the corresponding fable to gently correct them (e.g., The Cricket and the Winter for Optimism Bias, The Shy Firefly for the Mere-Exposure effect).
4. **Select the Service Level:** Based on the client's complexity and budget, deploy either the 'Full' Framework (3-5 meetings, layered basis) or the 'Lite' Programme (1 meeting focused on 3 key domains to reduce cost).
5. **Review Core Fundamentals:** Go through the table of Growth Stage Fundamentals to ensure the client practices the required habits (e.g., understanding the 8 Profit Levers in Design/Break-even).

Common Q&A:

1. *What does the framework DO for the client?* It creates "Self Relevance," which is critical for both learning and developing the motivation to want to act.
2. *What is the difference between the 'Lite' and 'Full' frameworks?* The 'Full' version is comprehensive, takes 3-5 meetings (10+ hours), targets \$30k+ fees, and uses an extensive online tool-box. The 'Lite' version limits scope to 1 meeting and 3 domains to cater to clients who cannot afford the full service.
3. *What fable is used to explain 'Confirmation Bias'?* The story of The Bear and the Salmon, where the bear ignores reality to support his current view and avoids the truth.
4. *What does the fable of 'Barney the Badger' teach?* It teaches Complacency; that past success doesn't guarantee future security and consistent effort is essential.
5. *What is the 'Mere-Exposure Effect'?* It is the psychological phenomenon where people develop a preference for things merely because they are familiar with them, acting as a barrier to challenging the unknown.
6. *Why must an organism undergo homeostasis?* Before expansion can occur, there must be a period of dormancy to 're-group' prior to expending energy in pursuit of gain.

BRANCH CHAIN LOGIC TABLE

Logic Branch	IF (Condition / Trigger)	THEN (Action / Next Step)	Additional Context / Notes
Service Tiering	IF client exhibits low fee tolerance OR requires a shorter engagement scope	THEN deploy the 'Lite' Fundamentals Framework	Limits the sales process to 1 meeting and focuses on just 3 key discussion domains to build early confidence.
Service Tiering	IF client has high complexity, multiple stakeholders, and tolerance for \$30k+ fees	THEN deploy the 'Full' Growth Fundamentals Framework	Involves 3-5 meetings (10+ hours) using the full 9 Growth Aspects and over 100 online toolbox templates.
Plateau Navigation	IF client is extremely fatigued AND stuck transitioning from 'Lifestyle' to 'Leverage'	THEN introduce the "Devil's Toilet" concept	Advise them to 'bank their profits' and improve systems before attempting to navigate this treacherous rapid.

Psyche Error: Confirmation Bias	IF client avoids reality, ignores negative data to support a false view, OR repeats the same mistakes	THEN share 'The Bear and the Salmon' fable	Helps them see they are misinterpreting 'singular focus' for 'ignoring reality' (Cognitive Dissonance).
Psyche Error: Complacency	IF client shows inability to focus on external environments after reaching perceived security	THEN share 'Barney the Badger' fable	Occurs often during 'Orientation' layer; driven by the mind/body's need to recover (Cathexis Energy).
Psyche Error: Optimism Bias	IF client seeks to delete all negative information to hold onto existing beliefs	THEN share 'The Cricket and the Winter' fable	Illustrates the danger of failing to prepare for inevitable hardship by maintaining an unrealistic perspective.
Psyche Error: Mere-Exposure	IF client avoids new markets and uses the phrase "this is how we've always done it"	THEN share 'The Shy Firefly and the Lonely Lantern' fable	Addresses the reluctance to challenge the known; a major roadblock in the 'Expansion' layer.
Psyche Error: Role Identification	IF client is inauthentic, mimics aspirational figures, OR acts how a 'Boss' should act	THEN share 'The Sparrow and the Hawk' fable	Crucial to address during the 'Succession' layer to help the owner find their true self before exiting.
Initial Consultation	IF advisor is introducing the framework for the very first time	THEN draw the curve freehand using the 3x3 chunk method	Utilize a persona (like Bob the Chocolate maker) to ensure 3rd person delivery and avoid client defensiveness.